

Philipp Chapkovski

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Profile

Postdoctoral researcher in behavioural economics and finance, developing computational experimentation for public policy, financial technology, and AI systems. Expertise in experimental economics, online and laboratory experiments, trading platforms, causal inference, and computational social science. Research focuses on financial technology, information avoidance, political polarisation, cooperation, solidarity, and behavioural responses to digital and institutional environments. Designs complex behavioural research systems that combine human participants, algorithmic agents, real-time interaction, API-based workflows, and structured behavioural data pipelines.

Core methods and technical stack

- Experimental economics, online and laboratory experiments, causal inference, and computational social science.
- Policy-relevant behavioural data collection using real-time, multi-user, and longitudinal experimental designs.
- Data analysis, data cleaning, and reproducible statistical workflows in Python, R, and Stata, with Git-based version control.
- Custom experimental and human-AI research infrastructure using FastAPI, oTree, Vue, WebSockets, RabbitMQ, Git/GitHub, and database-backed behavioural logging.

Selected publications

2026 Trading Gamification and Investor Behavior (with Mariana Khapko and Marius Zoican) in *Management Science*.

(<https://doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.2022.02650>)

2026 Can corruption indices lead to statistical discrimination? Experimental evidence from a within-country setting. in *Public Choice*.

(<https://doi.org/10.1007/s11127-025-01367-1>)

2025 Gamified Risk-Taking (with Mariana Khapko and Marius Zoican) in *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance*.

(<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbef.2025.101049>)

2025 The effect of war on redistribution preferences (with Alexei Zakharov) in *Journal of Public Economics*.

(<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jpubeco.2024.105284>)

2025 Cross-impact and price bubbles in hybrid financial markets (with Francesco Cordon, Caterina Giannetti and Fabrizio Lillo) in *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*.

(<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socec.2025.102398>)

2024 Background Uncertainty Does Not Increase Risk Aversion in Decision Making (with Johannes Leder, Thomas Lauer, Astrid Schütz, and Özgür Gürerk) in *Scientific Reports*.

(<https://www.nature.com/articles/s41598-024-73650-y>)

Professional experience

March 2024 – present

Institute for Political Science, University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany

Postdoctoral researcher in ERC project PolitSolid

Designs and analyses experimental and survey-based studies on political solidarity, trust, public-service quality, and behavioural responses to social and political information. Contributes to Novaland, a virtual-state environment for studying institutional experience, corruption, redistribution, and citizen-state interaction.

- Oct 2022 – March 2024 **Institute for Applied Microeconomics, University of Bonn, Germany**
Postdoctoral researcher
 Developed online and lab experiments on information avoidance, polarisation, co-operation, and decision-making, with emphasis on causal identification and behavioural mechanisms. Built custom experimental platforms for real-time multi-user studies and platform-design experiments.
- May 2022 – Oct 2022 **WZB, Berlin Social Science Center, Germany**
Research Fellow, "Scholars at Risk" program
- Sept 2018 – April 2022 **International Laboratory for Experimental and Behavioural Economics, Higher School of Economics, Moscow, Russia**
Senior Research Fellow
 Designed online and laboratory experiments on cooperation, information avoidance, tax compliance, and market behaviour. Developed reusable oTree/Django tools and real-time experimental infrastructure for interactive behavioural studies.
- Oct 2016 – Jan 2018 **Institute of Sociology, University of Zurich, Switzerland**
Research Fellow
- Sept 2013 – May 2014 **Comparative Life Course and Inequality Research Centre, European University Institute, Italy**
Research Assistant

Education

- Sept 2018 **Ph.D in Sociology and Political Science**
 European University Institute, Florence, Italy
 Dissertation: *Collective Sanctions and Cooperation. Three Experimental Studies*
 Under supervision of Prof. Diego Gambetta
- May 2012 **MA in Social and Political Sciences**
 European University, St. Petersburg, Russia
 MA Thesis: *Analysis of Social Networks of Russian Federal Elites 2000-2008.*
- May 2010 **BA in Economics**
 University of Ca'Foscari, Venice, Italy
 BA Thesis: *Micro-consequences of Pension System Reforms in Post-Soviet Countries*

Publications

- 2026** "Can corruption indices lead to statistical discrimination? Experimental evidence from a within-country setting." in *Public Choice*
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s11127-025-01367-1>
- 2026, accepted** "Teaming up with Artificial Agents in Non-routine Analytical Tasks" (with Federico Galatolo, Lorenzo Cominelli, Caterina Giannetti et al.) accepted in *ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction*
<https://www.ec.unipi.it/documents/Ricerca/papers/2024-314.pdf>
- 2026** "Trading Gamification and Investor Behavior" (with Mariana Khapko and Marius Zoican) in *Management Science*
<https://doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.2022.02650>
- 2025** "The effect of war on redistribution preferences" (with Alexei Zakharov) in the *Journal of Public Economics*
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jpubeco.2024.105284>
- 2025** "Gamified Risk-Taking" (with Mariana Khapko and Marius Zoican) in *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance*
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbef.2025.101049>
- 2025** "Cross-impact and price bubbles in hybrid financial markets" (with Francesco Cordoni, Caterina Giannetti and Fabrizio Lillo) in *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socec.2025.102398>
- 2024** "Background Uncertainty Does Not Increase Risk Aversion in Decision Making" (with Johannes Leder, Thomas Lauer, Astrid Schütz, and Özgür Güler) in *Nature Scientific Reports*
<https://www.nature.com/articles/s41598-024-73650-y>

- 2024** "Appealing, Nudging or Threatening? Assessing Various Communication Strategies to Promote Tax Compliance" (with Andris Saulitis) in *Public Choice*
(<https://doi.org/10.1007/s11127-024-01194-w>)
- 2023** "Conducting Interactive Experiments in Toloka" in *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance* Volume 37, March 2023
(<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbef.2023.100790>)
- 2022** "Solid support or secret dissent? A list experiment on preference falsification during the Russian war against Ukraine." in *Research & Politics* 9, no. 2 20531680221108328.
(<https://doi.org/10.1177/20531680221108328>)
- 2022** "Information Avoidance in a Polarized Society" in *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*, 101, p.101940
(<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socec.2022.101940>)
- 2021** "Strike one hundred to educate one: Measuring the efficacy of collective sanctions experimentally" in *PLOS ONE* Vol. 16. No. 04. P. 1-21
(<https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0248599>)
- 2021** "Does Whistleblowing on Tax Evaders Reduce Ingroup Cooperation?" (with Luca Corazzini and Valeria Maggian) in *Frontiers in Psychology* Vol. 12. Article 732248
(<https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2021.732248>)
- 2019** "Introducing otree_tools: A Powerful Package to Expand Standard oTree Capabilities" (with Christian Zihlmann) in *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance* 23, 75–83
(<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbef.2019.04.010>)
- 2019** "Real Time Interactions in oTree Using Django Channels: Auctions and Real Effort Tasks" (with Essi Kujansuu) in *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance*, 23, 114-123.
(<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbef.2019.05.008>)

Working papers

- 2026 (Under review)** "Does Paying for Data Change Investment Decisions?" (with Arzu Isik, Mariana Khapko and Marius Zoican), under review in *Journal of Finance*
(https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=6136449)
- 2026 (Under review)** "How do retail investors use order flow data?" (with Mariana Khapko and Marius Zoican), under review in *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis*
(<https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5160381>)
- 2026 (Under review)** "Emotions in Hybrid Financial Markets" (with Lorenzo Cominelli, Gianluca Rho et al.), under review in *Journal of Economic Psychology*
(<https://www.ec.unipi.it/documents/Ricerca/papers/2024-311.pdf>)
- 2026 (Under review)** "Exploring Participant Engagement in Online Experiments: Attentiveness and Immersion as Moderators of Treatment Effects" (with Achim Goerres, Jakob Eicheler and Philipp C. Kemper), under review in *Behavioral Research Methods*
- 2025 (Under review)** "How the Experience of Public-Service Quality and Corruption Shapes Political Solidarity and Trust: Experimental Evidence from a Novel Virtual-State Approach" (with Achim Goerres, Jakob Eicheler and Philipp C. Kemper), under review in *European Journal of Political Research*
- 2025 (Working paper)** "Wartime hardship acts as contextual moderator of directionally motivated reasoning" (with Ivan Grigoriev)
Working paper based on a two-wave panel survey in Ukraine.
Short summary in LSE EUROPP blog: [summary](#)
- 2025 (Working paper)** "Thinking Alone, and Together: Dissenting Pairs Corrected More Faulty Decisions Than Solitary Reasoners Across Four Tasks" (with Simon Cullen and Nick Byrd)
(<https://osf.io/fp2z4/>)
- 2024 (Under review)** "Speak Up or Stay Silent: How Revealing War Positions Affects Affective Polarization in Russia" (with Alexei Zakharov) in *Research and Politics*
(<http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4355956>)
- 2024 (R&R)** "From WEIRD to GREAT? Exploring data quality of global platforms for online research" (with Eyal Peer and Elena Brandt) in *Psychological Methods*
(<https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/xvfnq>)

Teaching experience

Courses

- 2026 **Polarization and Populism: Causes, Consequences, and Policy Responses**
Seminar Course for Master's Students
University of Duisburg-Essen
- 2025 **Comparative politics module: Polarization and its behavioral consequences**
Seminar Course for Bachelor's Students
University of Duisburg-Essen
- 2019 **Experimental Methods in Political Science**
Undergraduate Course
BA Program in Political Science
Higher School of Economics, St. Petersburg, Russia
- Spring 2017 **Social Norms, Control and Punishment**
Undergraduate Course (Co-taught with Prof. Heiko Rauhut)
University of Zurich, Switzerland

Workshops

- June 2024 **Real-Time Online Behavioral Experiments**
Workshop for PhD Students in Organizational Psychology
University of Basel
- September 2023 **Designing Interactive Experiments with oTree**
Workshop
University of Pisa
- June 2020 **Behavioral Experimental Science Online and in the Lab**
Summer Institute in Computational Social Science
- August 2019 **Running Behavioral Experiments with oTree**
IMPRS Uncertainty Summer School
Max Planck Institute for Research on Collective Goods, Bonn, Germany
- July 2018 **Programming Behavioral Experiments**
Workshop
European Commission Joint Research Centre, Brussels, Belgium

Grants, prizes, fellowships

- 2024 Gorilla and Prolific Grant:** Study on political alignment and engagement in collaborative word encryption tasks using Gorilla's Multiplayer tools
- 2017** First Prize at the Conference/Hackathon 'Experimental Methods in Sociology Using oTree' in WZB Berlin Social Science Center.
- 2017** Grant for innovating teaching 'Lehrkredit', University of Zurich: "Using Mobile Lab in Teaching Analytical Sociology".

Conferences and Summer School Organization

- 2025** Co-organizer, PolitSolid Workshop, University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany
- 2021** Co-organizer, International Conference RExCon21 on 'Social Preferences and Social Norms'
<https://rexcon.hse.ru/2021/>
- 2021** Co-organizer, I Pacific School of Experimental Economics, Vladivostok
- 2019** Co-organizer, Summer School on "Experimental Economics: purposes, design, tools", St. Petersburg 2019

Selected presentations

- May 2024** "Political Polarization in the Workplace: Impact on Team Performance and Information Exchange". the 8th International Meeting on Experimental and Behavioral Social Sciences (IMEBESS), Riga, Latvia
- June 2023** "The sound of silence: understanding social avoidance in a Russian war context". Symposium "Social Science Research in the Context of Conflict, War, and Authoritarianism", London, UK.

July 2022 "Information avoidance in polarized society". 19th International Conference on Social Dilemmas. Copenhagen, Denmark.

June 2022 "Unintended consequences of corruption indices." 12th International Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics. Lyon, France.

May 2022 "Does gamified trading stimulate risk taking?", (with M.Zoican and M.Khapko), 4th Future of Financial Information Conference, Stockholm, Sweden

Reviewer for Academic Journals

- American Political Science Review
- British Journal of Political Science
- Comparative Political Studies
- European Sociological Review
- Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics
- Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance
- Behavior Research Methods
- Democratization
- Europe-Asia Studies
- Media, War & Conflict

Languages

English - fluent, Italian - fluent, German - professional working proficiency, Russian - native.